AZURE CREDITS & MICROSOFT FOUNDRY

Activate your credits.
Build your first AI agent.

THE CORE IDEA

Your $100 in Azure credits gives your team a place to experiment with real AI models.

In this guide you activate Azure for Students, create a Microsoft Foundry resource, and test your first agent in the playground.

01	02	03	04	05	06
ACTIVATE	SEARCH	CREATE	DEPLOY	OPEN	BUILD

BEFORE THE CHALLENGE

Set up early. Test before the event.

Activate your Azure credits

Do this first. Everything else runs on your student subscription.

01

OPEN THE STUDENT OFFER

Go to **azure.microsoft.com/free/students** and select the option to start free.

02

USE YOUR SCHOOL EMAIL

Sign in with your university email so Microsoft can verify you are a student.

03

VERIFY YOUR STATUS

Complete the verification steps on screen. When it finishes, your $100 credit is active.

04

OPEN THE AZURE PORTAL

Go to **portal.azure.com**. Your subscription appears as **Azure for Students**.

ASK YOUR TEAM

Your credits are a budget. Every model call spends tokens.

Track what you use, and stop or delete resources you no longer need. That is the same discipline Contoso needs.

☐	**SCHOOL EMAIL**	I can sign in with my university email.
☐	**CREDITS**	Azure for Students shows as an active subscription.
☐	**PORTAL**	I can open portal.azure.com and see the home page.

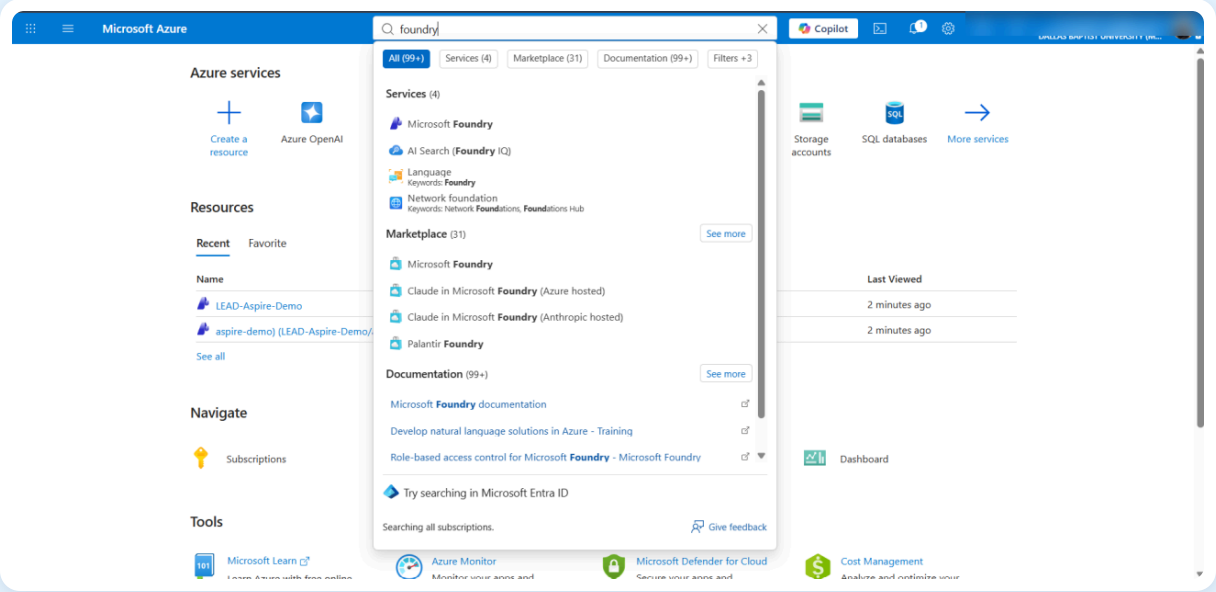
Find Microsoft Foundry

Microsoft Foundry is where you create, test, and deploy AI agents.

01

SEARCH FOR FOUNDRY

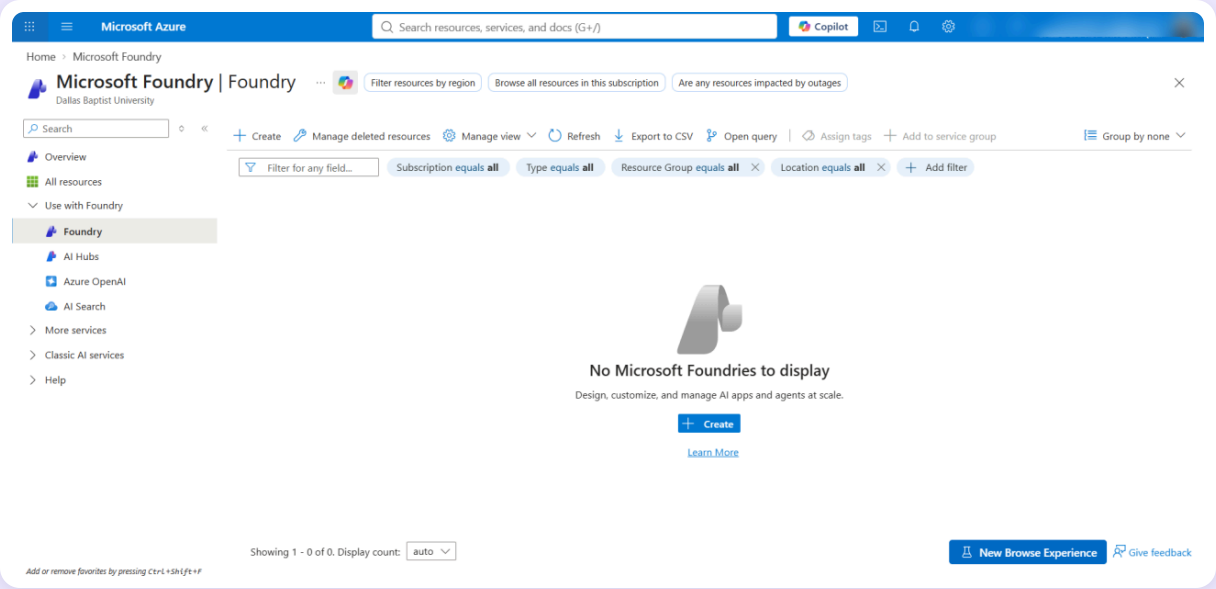
In the search bar at the top of the Azure portal, type `foundry`. Select **Microsoft Foundry** under Services.



02

SELECT CREATE

On the Microsoft Foundry page, select **+ Create**. If this is your first resource, the list is empty.



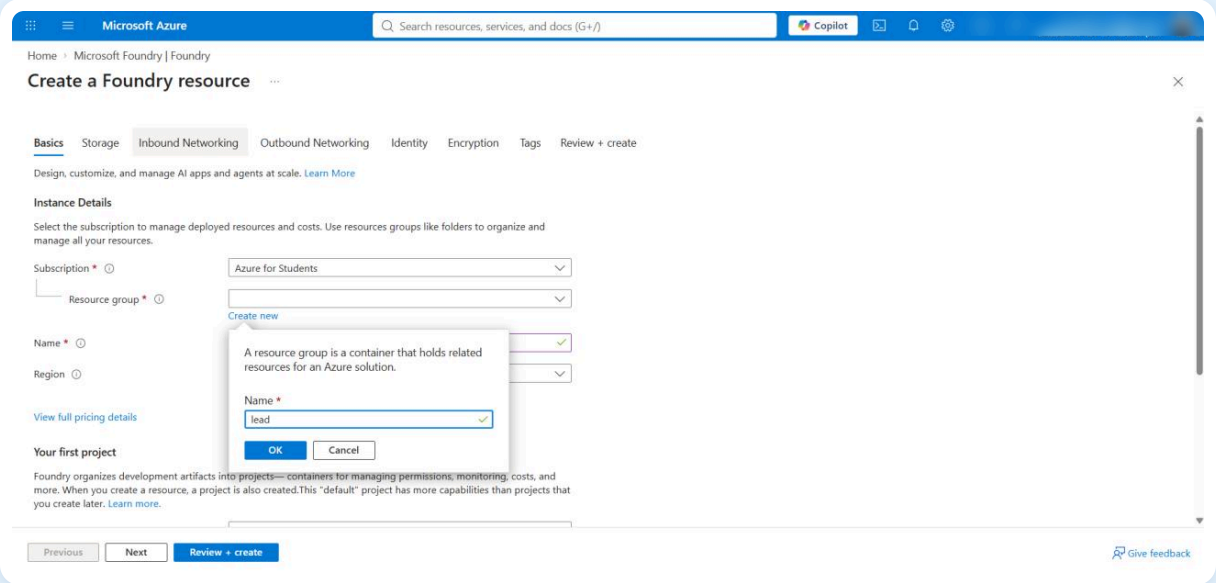
Set up your resource

Fill in the Basics tab. Use simple names your team will recognize.

03

CHOOSE SUBSCRIPTION AND RESOURCE GROUP

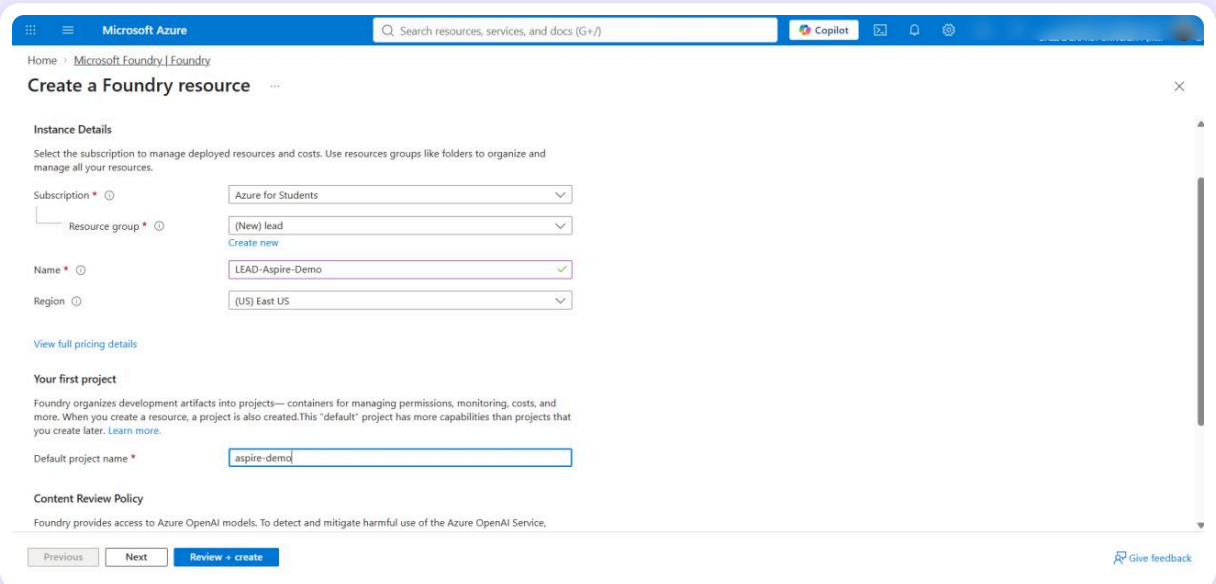
Set **Subscription** to **Azure for Students**. Under **Resource group**, select **Create new** and enter a name, for example `lead`. Select **OK**.



04

NAME YOUR RESOURCE AND PROJECT

Enter a **Name** for the resource, for example `LEAD-Aspire-Demo`. Choose a **Region** near you, such as East US. Enter a **Default project name**.



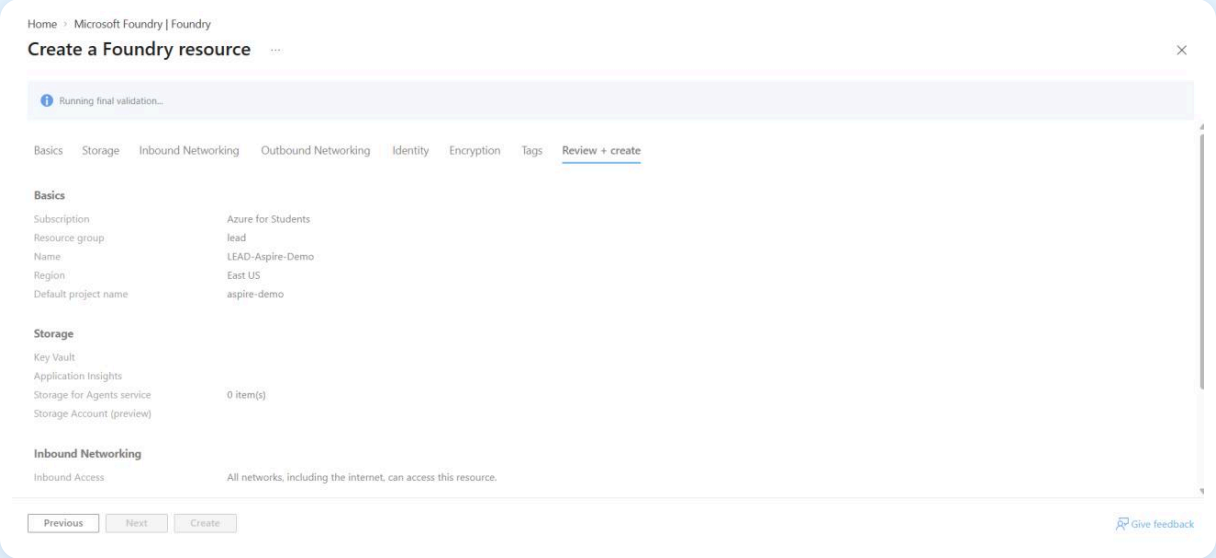
Review and deploy

Azure checks your settings, then builds the resource for you.

05

SELECT REVIEW + CREATE

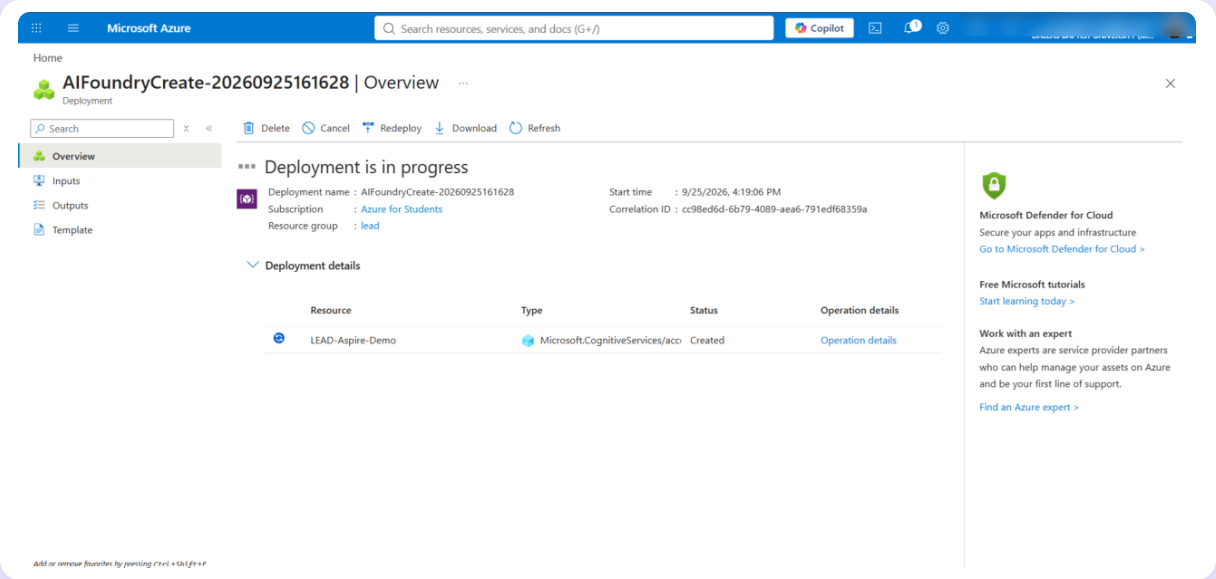
Select **Review + create**. Check the summary, then select **Create**.



06

WAIT FOR THE DEPLOYMENT

You will see **Deployment is in progress**. This takes a couple of minutes. Do not close the page.



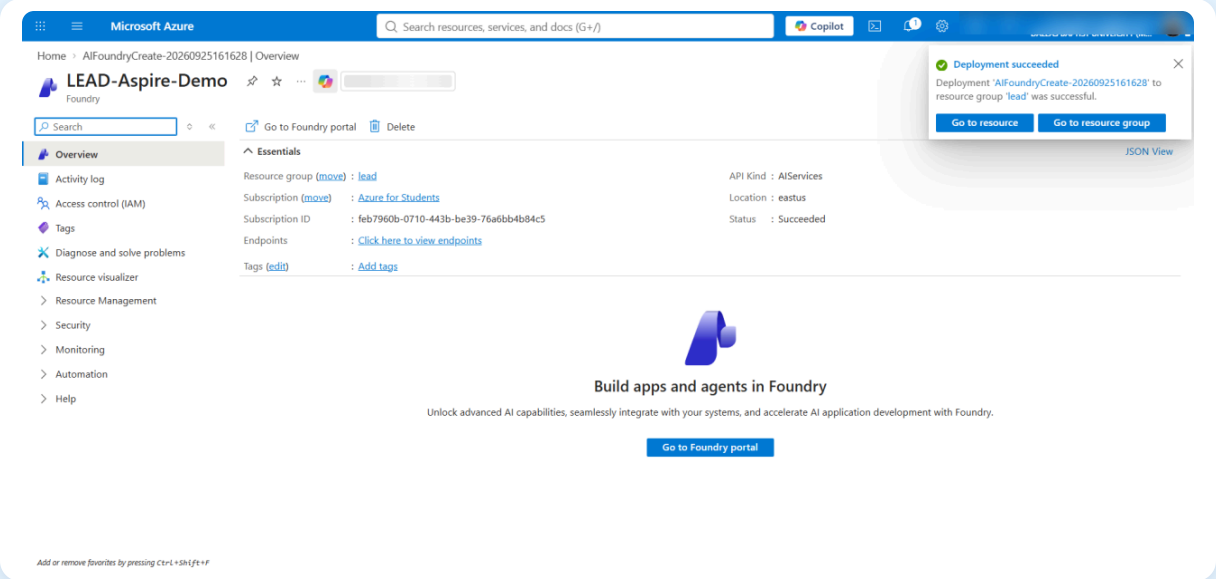
Open the Foundry portal

Your resource is ready. Now move from Azure into Foundry.

07

GO TO THE FOUNDRY PORTAL

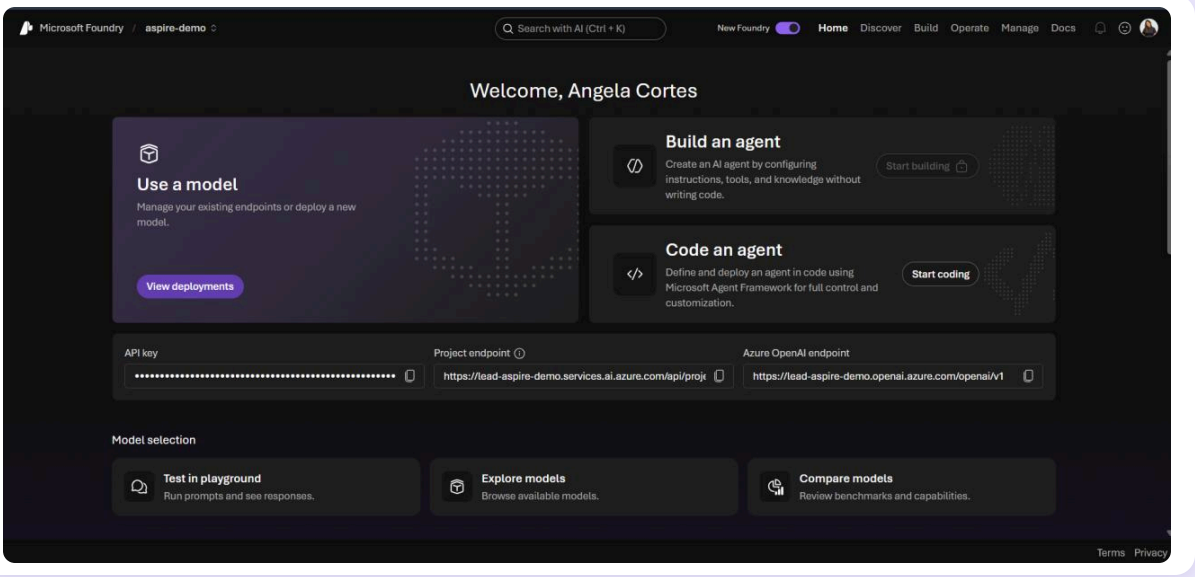
When the deployment succeeds, open your resource and select **Go to Foundry portal**.



08

OPEN THE PLAYGROUND

On the Foundry home page, find **Model selection** and select **Test in playground**.



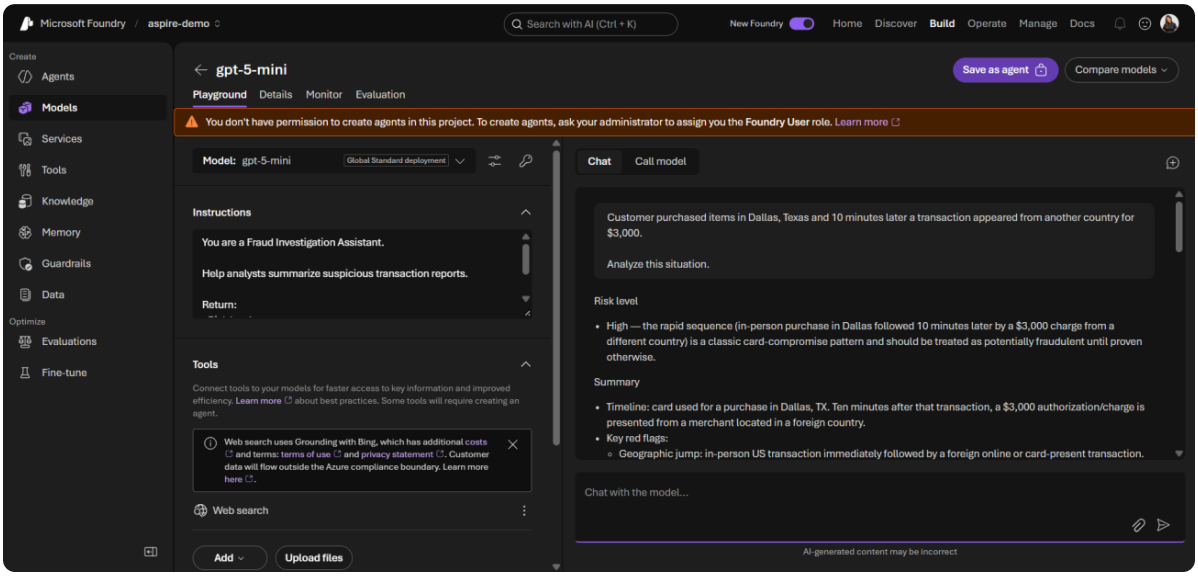
Create your own agent

Give the model a role, test it, and save it as an agent.

09

WRITE INSTRUCTIONS AND TEST

Pick a model. In **Instructions**, describe the role of your agent and what it should do. Type a test message in the chat. When you like the results, select **Save as agent**.



PROTECT YOUR KEYS

Foundry shows an API key and endpoints on the home page.

Never paste keys into code, slides, prompts, or screenshots. If you see a permission warning when you save an agent, ask an event organizer.

☐	**RESOURCE**	My Foundry resource deployed successfully.
☐	**PLAYGROUND**	I sent a test message and got a response.
☐	**KEYS**	My API key is not in any file, slide, or screenshot.